

The Stack Today

Every request to the hall passes through three shore-side tiers. This is the whole off-fleet surface.

THE NERVOUS SYSTEM

CLOUDFLARE

DNS · Workers (proxy + mint) · KV · R2 · CDN

Voice pipeline, economy, court, god-view — all run here.

THE VAULT

SUPABASE

Postgres · subscribers · user data · auth

The crown jewels: who the people are. The list itself.

THE RELAY

RESEND

Send-only · rides Amazon SES

Hands the newsletter to Gmail with a good reputation.

Ranked by Lock-In

The tiers are not equal. Rank them not by size, but by how hard they are to leave.

The deepest dependency is the real risk — not the loudest.

1

CLOUDFLARE WORKERS

DEEPEST LOCK-IN

Written to Cloudflare’s runtime — KV, R2, the edge model. Leaving means a REWRITE, and it touches the load-bearing voice pipeline. This is t

2

SUPABASE

MEDIUM

Holds the crown jewels, but it is just Postgres. Portable to another Postgres host as a MIGRATION, not a rewrite.

3

RESEND

TRIVIAL

Send-only. Swappable in an afternoon — revoke the key, repoint four DNS records. Least concern of the three.

Blast Radius

If each vendor fails — or you must leave — what actually breaks?

IF IT FAILS

CLOUDFLARE FAILS

The hall goes dark.

- Voice stops (proxy Worker)
- Economy / court / leaderboards stop (mint)
- DNS may drop — the whole site unreachable
- Recovery: a rewrite onto new compute

IF IT FAILS

SUPABASE FAILS

The list is imperiled.

- Signups stop writing
- The subscriber list is unreachable
- But data is exportable Postgres
- Recovery: restore to any Postgres host

IF IT FAILS

RESEND FAILS

A quiet inconvenience.

- The newsletter can't send
- Nothing else is touched
- The list, site, voice all keep running
- Recovery: swap provider in an afternoon

Two Strategies

‘Closer to home’ means two opposite things. Choosing the principle first is the founder’s call.

STRATEGY A

Own Everything

Minimize dependency · self-host

Fewer vendors. Depend on no one.

GAINS:

- No third party holds your keys
- Full control of the pipe

COSTS:

- You own uptime, backups, patching
- You own deliverability & reputation
- Failure is INVISIBLE (silent non-delivery)
- For a solo captain: more fragile, not less

STRATEGY B

One Bedrock

Consolidate on one US provider

One accountable entity. US jurisdiction.

GAINS:

- Fewer contracts, one strong foundation
- Enterprise durability & support
- Legal accountability in one place

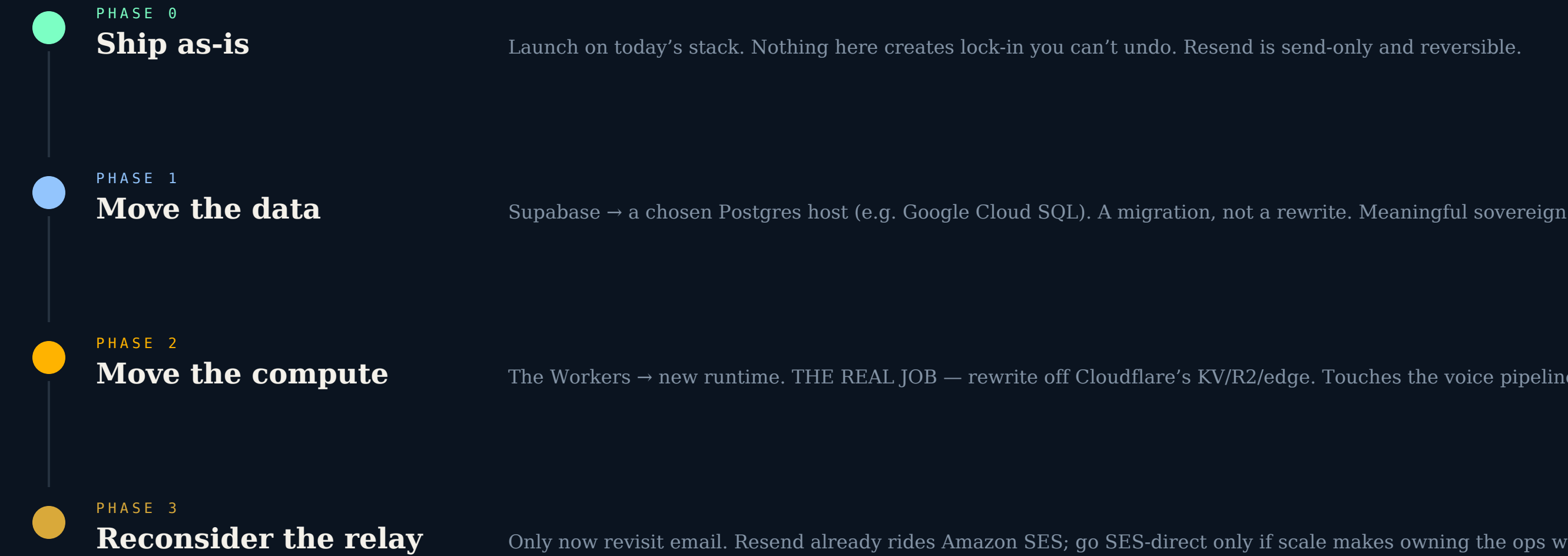
COSTS:

- Still a dependency — just concentrated
- Migration effort (esp. the Workers)
- Trust vested in a single provider

→ The wiser path for a business.

The Migration Roadmap

Should you choose one bedrock: stage it easy → hard. The trivial vendor moves last; the deep one is the real work.



Rank by lock-in, not by anxiety. A dependency you understand and can exit is a choice — not a vulnerability.